



free will
and
determinism

A large orange circle with a subtle drop shadow, containing the text "against compatibilist free will" in white, bold, sans-serif font.

**against
compatibilist
free will**

against
incompatibilist
free will

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the reality of free will.

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

A compatibility believer in free will rejects premise (1). An incompatibilist believer in free will rejects premise (2).

This is the consequence argument.

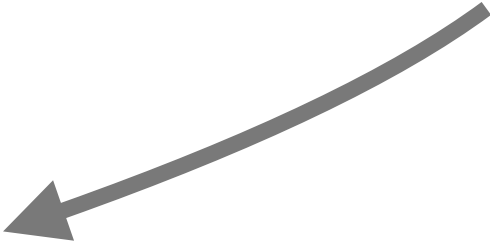
Now that we have a grip on determinism and on one view of free will which would arguably be compatible with determinism, let's look at the central argument against the view that free will is compatible with determinism.

No one has any choice about the
state of the world in the
distant past.

No one has any choice
about what the laws of
nature are.

No one has any choice about the combination of the state of the world in the distant past + the laws of nature.





If determinism is true,
then the state of the
world in the distant past
+ the laws of nature
necessitate every future
action.

But now recall a principle we discussed last time: the No Choice/
Necessitation principle.

If we have no choice about some facts, and those facts necessitate X , we have no choice about X .

reality of free will.

We can lay out this puzzle in terms of the following master argument against the



The master argument against the reality of free will

Compatibility believers in free will reject premise (1). An incompatibilist

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Now that we have a grip on determinism and on our view of free will

which arguably be compatible with determinism, let's look at the



No one has any choice about the

states that the world is the

distasteful.



about what the laws of

in air.

None has any choice



laws of nature.

world in the distant past + the

convinced that it is the best way to

None has any choice about the



need sit at every fire

world in the distant past

the first state of the

act in in.

If deterring is true,

the laws of nature

Necessitation principle.

discussed last time: the No Choice/

But now recall a principle we



if acts, and those if acts

If we have no choice about some

needless to say, we have no choice

advent

x.

or premise (3) is true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise (2)

for (2), and one for (3).



1. No one has any choice about events which



6. If $\det A$ is true, then A has any

then DECISION. (4,5)

and none has any choice about whether,

3. If determined, the only one

about whether @.

the idealist that is NOT AUR

varlatatie + the last of the



2. None has any choice about DIDS. ATJR.

nature say that if DINS ARE happy,

then DECISION happens. (3)

happened in the distant past.

5. No one has any choice about what the laws

C. If determinist is true, then no one has any

~ If none has about choice about whether P,

of interest.

if P , then Q , then one has any choice

future is not just what the state of the

choice about DECISION (2, 6, 7)

4. If determinism is true, the laws of



rules out free will.

choice about the laws of nature, then no

combination of four - that No

choice principle, and determinism

This argument seems to show that the

one has any choice about the past, no

dearminism.

seems to show that if determinism is

true, there are no free actions — and

hence that free will is incompatible with

seem quite plausible, the argument

Since the first three of these theses



Real/|the master argument:

The consequence argument is a defense of premise (1). If you believe

in free will, and find the consequent argument persuasive, it looks

tempting to reply to the master argument by denying premise (2).

against
compatibilist
free will

A large red circle with a slight drop shadow, containing white text. The text is arranged in three lines, centered within the circle.

**against
incompatibilist
free will**

1. Free will is incompatible with determinism.
 2. If Libertarianism is true, then there is no free will.
-

C. There is no free will.

The master argument against the reality of free will

Let's start with the first premise, which says that free will is incompatible

argument.

with determinism. The main argument for this premise is the consequence

true. We're now going to look at two arguments — one for the first

Now, so far we have been given no reason to think that either premise is

premise, and on the second premise.

One way to present this argument starts with two very plausible premises.

[REDACTED]

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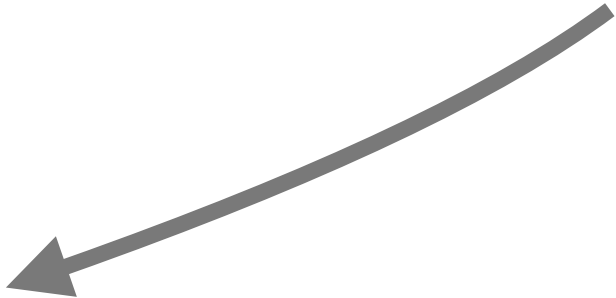


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